

# Core merch

One logo tee in four colors, a tote that only comes in gift bundles, and the inside-neck label and hang tag that carry the brand name on every order.

Adult sizes only

Print on demand

No inventory

Slogan tees wait for clearance



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# Three design slots. One is ready.

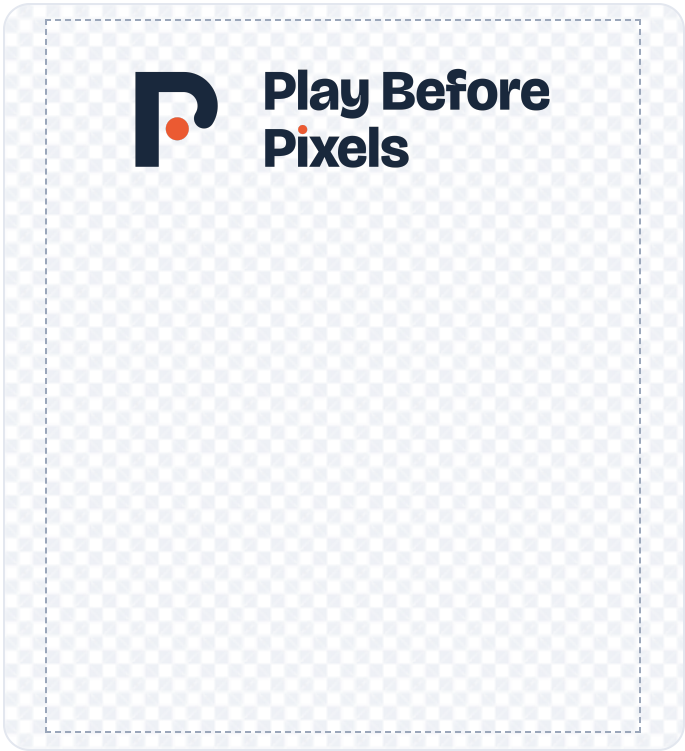
DEMAND-CHECK.md allows at most three adult designs, as identity merch rather than a merch line. The logo tee is ready to set up. The two slogan slots stay empty until a slogan is cleared.

| ITEM                      | STATUS                       | FILES                                           | EVERYDAY PRICE                    | SOLD ON                                      |
|---------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Logo tee<br>design 1 of 3 | Ready to set up              | print/tee-logo_light<br>and _dark (.png + .svg) | \$27 XS–XL<br>\$29 2XL · \$31 3XL | Own site, Etsy,<br>Amazon Merch on<br>Demand |
| Slogan tee<br>slot 2      | Blocked<br>no cleared slogan | slogan-slot/ template<br>only                   | –                                 | –                                            |
| Slogan tee<br>slot 3      | Blocked                      | –                                               | –                                 | –                                            |
| Logo tote                 | Bundle add-on only           | print/tote-<br>logo_light and _dark             | +\$22 inside a bundle             | Own-site bundles<br>only                     |
| Inside-neck label         | Fill in 2 fields             | labels/ 7 sizes × light<br>and dark             | included                          | printed by the<br>partner                    |
| Hang tag / pack-in        | Optional                     | hang-tag.pdf (site and<br>marketplace editions) | included                          | only if the partner<br>offers it             |

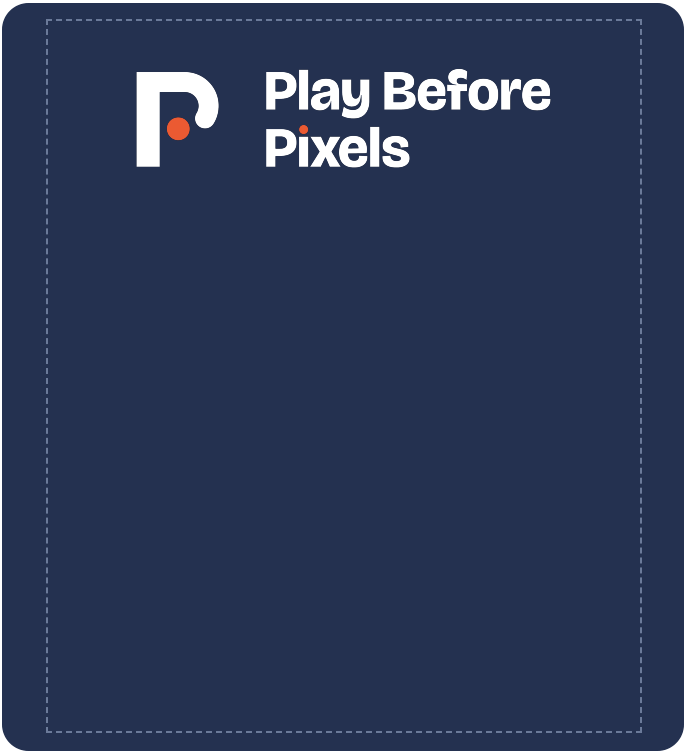
## SIX RULES FOR THIS LINE

- **Grown-up sizes only.** No kids' tees or onesies: they need children's-product testing and a certificate (DEMAND-CHECK cut, CAMPAIGN-BIBLE [CPSIA]).
- **Print on demand only.** The partner prints and ships each order. Nothing is ever stocked, packed or shipped by the founder.
- **The logo comes from brand/Logo/ , unaltered.** No retyping, recoloring, effects or new lockups.
- **™, never ®.** PLAY BEFORE PIXELS is not registered or filed yet.
- **No slogan without clearance** in brand/ORIGINALITY.md, and never an event name.
- **No condition words** (autism, delay, therapy) on merch, listings, tags or ads.

# Front print files



**tee-logo\_light** · ink P, tomato ball · for White, Natural and Mustard.  
Dashed line = the 15 × 18 in canvas.



**tee-logo\_dark** · paper P, tomato ball (the kit's reverse) · for Navy

| SPEC        | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Canvas      | 4500 × 5400 px, transparent PNG stamped 300 dpi (15 × 18 in). The .svg twin is pure vector (logo paths from the kit).                                                                                     |
| Artwork     | Horizontal lockup, the kit's default. Ink about 10.5 in wide × 2.5 in tall, centered left to right.                                                                                                       |
| Position    | Ink starts about 1.2 in below the top of the print area, so it sits high on the chest. Check it on the partner's mockup: aim for 3–3.5 in below the collar seam [VERIFY on the partner's placement tool]. |
| Colors      | Ink #1D2940 · tomato #EE5A36 · paper #FFFFFF. Nothing else.                                                                                                                                               |
| Size checks | Minimum print width for the lockup is 40 mm: this is 267 mm. The gaps around the ball print at about 4.5 mm (floor 1.5 mm).                                                                               |
| Method      | Direct-to-garment (DTG). For embroidery, use the kit's one-color files and its embroidery minimums instead: this file is not for stitching.                                                               |

# Four garment colors

Light garments take the full-color logo. Navy is the garment closest to ink, so it takes the reverse. Black, grass and plum garments are left out on purpose: the kit allows only white one-color logos on them, and they are off-palette.



○ White · tee-logo\_light



○ Natural · tee-logo\_light



● Mustard · tee-logo\_light



● Navy · tee-logo\_dark

## FOUNDER'S CHOICE · HUMAN AUTHORSHIP

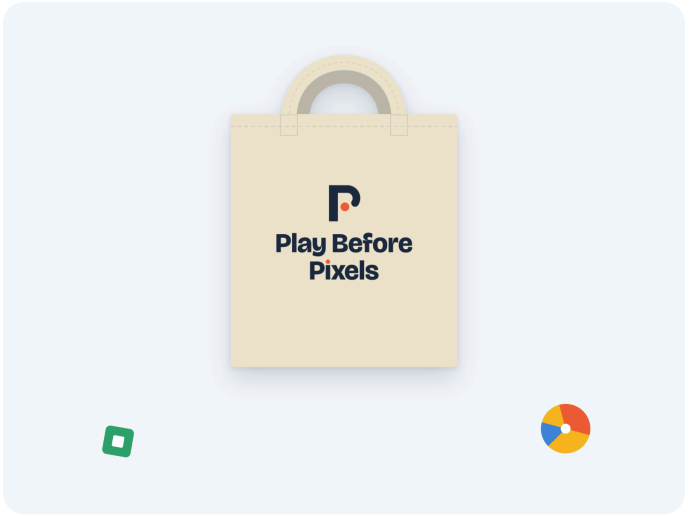
Confirm or change the four colors (use the partner's closest named color and check each against a physical sample). Your choices are part of your creative contribution: write them here and commit.

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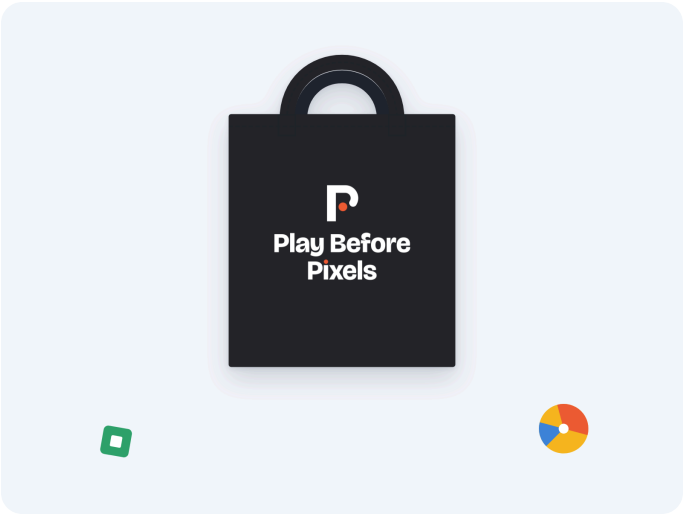
BUNDLE ADD-ON

# Logo tote

The tote is never listed on its own (DEMAND-CHECK: bundle-only). It is a +\$22 add-on inside own-site gift bundles.



Natural canvas · tote-logo\_light



Black · tote-logo\_dark

| SPEC             | VALUE                                                                                                                                      |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Canvas           | 3600 × 3600 px, transparent PNG at 300 dpi (12 × 12 in), plus vector .svg.                                                                 |
| Artwork          | Stacked lockup, the kit's lockup for tote bags. Ink about 9 in wide, centered and raised 0.4 in so it clears the bottom seam.              |
| Where it appears | Holiday gift bundle (tee + tote + a digital play kit) and any later gift bundle. Teacher bundles stay on hold with all school-facing work. |
| Check            | Tote print areas differ by blank: confirm the partner's area and shrink the canvas if it is smaller than 12 × 12 in [VERIFY].              |

**BUNDLE MATH, THE HONEST WAY**

Example: logo tee (\$27) + logo tote (+\$22) + a digital play kit, sold as one own-site checkout. Price the bundle 10–25% under the sum of its parts and say so in plain words (“\$X, or \$Y bought separately”). Never show the separate total as a crossed-out price. The print partner ships the tee and tote; the play kit arrives by email.

# Inside-neck label

The brand name **PIXELS** printed inside the neck is how clothing shows a trademark in use (a front logo alone can be seen as decoration). Every tee carries it.

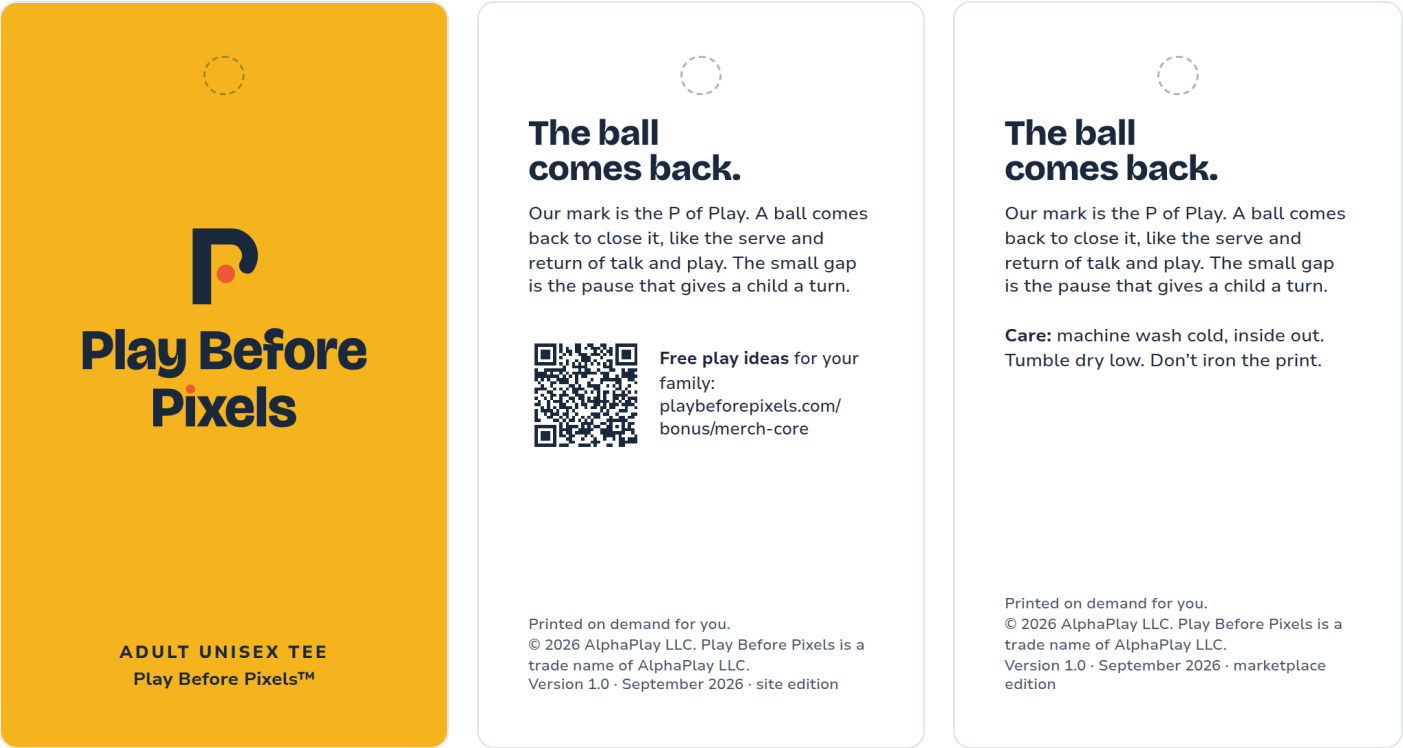


| SPEC           | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Files          | labels/neck-label_SIZE_light dark , 900 × 900 px (3 × 3 in at 300 dpi), .png + vector .svg [VERIFY against the partner's inside-label template].                                                                                                                                                                            |
| On every label | Horizontal lockup · size · ADULT UNISEX · PLAY BEFORE PIXELS™ · AlphaPlay LLC (the business named on the label) · care · fiber and country of origin.                                                                                                                                                                       |
| You fill in    | Fiber content and country of origin come from the blank you choose. Type them into <code>BLANK</code> at the top of <code>build/build.py</code> and run <code>build/render.sh</code> . Until then the labels print a tomato FILL IN box, so they cannot go out by mistake. Check care wording against the blank's spec too. |
| ALPHAPLAY      | These tees do not help the ALPHAPLAY filing: its clothing class covers sports pinnies only. Do not add ALPHAPLAY to the tee.                                                                                                                                                                                                |

OPTIONAL

# Hang tag and pack-in card

2 × 3.5 in, 0.125 in bleed on every edge, text 0.25 in from the page edge. Use it only if the partner offers branded hang tags or pack-in inserts [VERIFY]; otherwise it doubles as the gift note image on the product page.



Front · on sun: ink P, tomato ball

Back, site edition · QR and short link to the free bonus

Back, marketplace edition · no URL or QR (Etsy)

The dashed circle marks where a hole would be punched; it is a guide for the printer, not art. Print file: `hang-tag.pdf` (page 1 front, page 2 site back, page 3 marketplace back).

| WHERE THE ORDER COMES FROM | WHICH BACK                     | WHY                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------|--------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| playbeforepixels.com       | Site edition (QR + short link) | Every product leads to the free bonus and the next product.                                                |
| Etsy                       | Marketplace edition            | Etsy editions carry no URL or QR (customer-voice rule 2); Etsy does not allow sending buyers off-platform. |
| Amazon Merch on Demand     | None                           | Amazon prints its own packaging; no inserts.                                                               |

# Slogan tees are on hold

No slogan is cleared yet: `brand/ORIGINALITY.md` does not exist. So this line ships with the logo tee only.

## Never use

- “Pencils before pixels” (the matching domain is in use by someone else)
- “Childhood can't wait. Screens can.” and “Paper first” (held until cleared)
- Any event's name, and any condition word
- Lines that read as superior or shaming (the campaign bible flagged “Built, Not Downloaded”)

## How a slogan gets onto a tee

1. Write 5–10 lines in your own words (that is your authorship).
2. Tone check: warm, zero shame, no fear words. Then a knockout search and, ideally, the attorney's look.
3. Record the winner as CLEARED in `brand/ORIGINALITY.md`.
4. Add it to `SLOGANS` in `build/build.py` and run `build/render.sh`. The script stops if the line is not marked cleared there.



Layout guide: 11 × 5 in slogan area, brand sign-off below.  
Not a print file.

### FOUNDER SLOT · YOUR SLOGAN IDEAS

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# Putting it on sale

1. **Pick one print partner** (Printful, Printify or Gelato, per `commerce/storefront-setup-guide.md`) that offers DTG on all four colors, inside-neck label printing, and both Etsy and the site's store integration.
2. **Pick one mid-weight unisex cotton blank.** Save its size chart. Fill in fiber and origin in `build/build.py`, then run `build/render.sh`.
3. **Create the tee.** Upload `tee-logo_light.png` to White, Natural and Mustard and `tee-logo_dark.png` to Navy. Sizes XS–3XL. Match the placement on page 3.
4. **Add the labels,** light files for light colors and dark files for Navy, one per size. If labels are not offered, remove the label panel from listing image 4 before listing.
5. **Order one sample per color.** Check print, colors, label and fit, wash one five times, and photograph it on a flat surface (faceless: hands at most).
6. **Etsy:** list the partner as your production partner, mark the item “Designed by” you, disclose the digital and AI tools used for the art, add the size chart, and upload listing images 1–7 in order.
7. **Own site:** the same listing, plus the tote bundle and the “Next for you” links (see `listing.json`).
8. **Amazon Merch on Demand:** apply; upload the same 4500 × 5400 files with brand “Play Before Pixels”. Approval and design-slot limits apply [VERIFY current terms].
9. **Money and tax:** give the partner your resale certificate, set the shipping profile, and write the returns line (the partner replaces misprints and damage; you decide on size exchanges).

**Runs without you:** orders go straight to the partner; tracking and delivery emails are automatic; the FAQ in `listing.json` answers sizing, care, timing and returns.

## What buyers ask (already answered in `listing.json`)

### Do you make kids' sizes?

No. Adult unisex XS–3XL only.

### How long does it take?

Each tee is printed when you order, then shipped with tracking.

### How does it fit?

Unisex fit; measure a tee you love and match the chart.

### Can I buy the tote?

It comes only inside gift bundles on our site.

# Prices and money

| ITEM                | EVERYDAY PRICE    | PARTNER COST                         | KEEP PER SALE                    |
|---------------------|-------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| Logo tee XS–XL      | \$27              | fill in from the partner, with label | aim for \$8 or more after fees   |
| Logo tee 2XL        | \$29              | fill in                              | same target                      |
| Logo tee 3XL        | \$31              | fill in                              | same target                      |
| Tote (bundle only)  | +\$22 in a bundle | fill in                              | same target                      |
| Holiday gift bundle | \$59 with a tee   | tee + deck/print costs               | planned bundle (DEMAND-CHECK #8) |

Bigger sizes cost the partner more, so they cost more here. Etsy fees are roughly a 6.5% transaction fee, payment processing and a listing fee [VERIFY current rates]. If a tee keeps less than \$8, raise the everyday price before launch, never by “discounting” later.

## NEVER

- A crossed-out or “was” price
- A permanent sale or countdown
- “Only 3 left”: print on demand never runs out

## FINE

- A real launch week that really ends
- Black Friday, if it truly ends
- Bundles 10–25% under the parts

## When it sells

- **Late October:** list with the holiday gift bundle. Check the partner's holiday order cut-off dates [VERIFY].
- **March:** spring screen-free week season. Say “spring screen-free week” in plain words; never print or claim the event's name.
- **Kill rule:** fewer than 5 sales in 60 days with the listing fixed → reprice once, then make it bundle-only.

# Checks and launch list

## Done in this build

- Tee files 4500 × 5400, transparent, 300 dpi, light + dark
- Tote files 3600 × 3600, transparent, light + dark
- Logo placed from brand/logo unaltered; lockup above its minimum size
- Label and tag carry PLAY BEFORE PIXELS™ (™, not ®)
- Adult sizes only; no slogan; no condition or event words
- Etsy images carry no URL or QR
- Copyright line and version on the book and tag

## The founder does

- ☐ Fill in fiber and origin; rebuild
- ☐ Order one physical sample per color; wash-test one
- ☐ Approve the sample photos and the cover image
- ☐ Written QA pass on the listing text
- ☐ Logo checks before public use: reverse-image search, USPTO design-code search, attorney knockout (logo guidelines, page 9)
- ☐ Insurance in place before the first sale (protection plan)
- ☐ Keep dated order records and label photos as trademark evidence

**Printer templates change.** Check every file against the chosen partner's current template and placement tool before upload.

### HONEST AUTHORSHIP

The logo art was drawn with AI-assisted tools. Answer every platform's AI question truthfully (Etsy asks), and never register AI-made art as your own work.

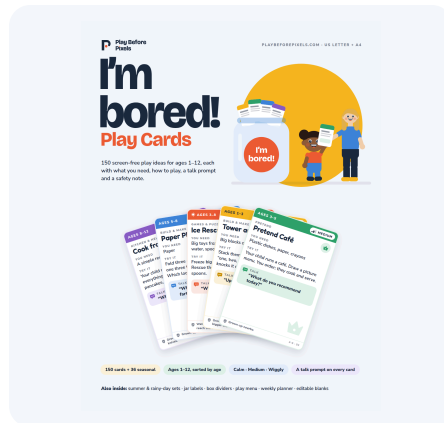
Your own contribution is the part you can protect: your color choices (page 4), your slogans (page 8) and your dated edits to the logo's build numbers. Commit each change to git so it is provable.

MORE FROM PLAY BEFORE PIXELS

# Next for the people who wear it



**The Day the Tablet Slept**  
Funny bedtime read-aloud, ages 3–7



**150 "I'm bored!" Play Cards**  
Printable, ages 1–12



**100 Screen-Free Plays**  
Activity book, ages 0–5



## Free play ideas for your family

[playbeforepixels.com/bonus/merch-core](https://playbeforepixels.com/bonus/merch-core) · email only, with your child's birth month and year if you like.  
No names.



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